



Stepping up: Sam Curran stood in as Punjab Kings captain in the absence of Shikhar Dhawan, who missed majority of the games in this IPL due to a shoulder injury. **R. V. MOORTHY**

might not always work, but you can reap great rewards from doing that.

I just hope the game keeps developing in a fair way. The IPL is such a great tournament, so everyone wants to see lots of runs. That said, there's nothing better than some good bowling as well. It's been a fantastic competition in that regard.

In this edition, teams scoring 240-plus has become the norm. So, from a bowler's point of view, how crucial is mental conditioning?

Yeah, the mental aspect is very

important. The IPL is a long tournament; there are lots of games, both home and away. You just have to look at a team like RCB (Royal Challengers Bengaluru) and see how they've found some rhythm in the last couple of games.

You have always got to keep believing when you have a bad day. You wake up the next day, stay positive, and keep your mindset good. As a captain, I have tried to keep the mood in the camp positive.

The management does that as well. We've lost some games, some close ones as well, and that can be quite tough because you play some good cricket and still lose. Each team has such good players, so the tournament is even. Anyone can beat anyone on their day. That's the fantastic thing about the tournament. It's just about winning

those crucial moments. You just have to keep believing that things will turn around and that you're there for a reason.

Sometimes, if you do have a tough day, don't be too hard on yourself because there are a lot of games to come.

As captain, how did you handle the challenge of Punjab Kings losing six out of seven home games in Mullanpur and Dharamshala, especially given the absence of Dhawan?

Of course, our home record hasn't been amazing. It was just putting together that perfect game we struggled with, particularly at home. I wouldn't say it's got to do anything with the home ground or the home conditions. It's fair for both teams on the same day; unfortunately, we just